

with the fact that our Razer products, in some markets, came bundled with Bose headsets in some markets outside of India. But we decided to leverage that partnership and took it to the next level where we've worked with them to design the Moto Buds+ end to end.

So, Bose has partnered with us to give their inputs in terms of design, in terms of sound quality, in terms of tuning, in terms of equalisation, in terms of all the learnings that they have from their consumers and their expertise on sound quality. So that is something that has given us a massive edge. And Moto Buds+ actually comes with a certification which says "Sound by Bose" and Bose only gives that certification if it believes that the sound is equivalent to a Bose headset. The Buds+ also come with a lot of other features which are top-notch in the segment.

The same learnings that we've got from the co-development of the Buds Plus helped us design Moto Buds, which comes at a far more accessible price point, and it was important for us to give two options to our consumers because our smartphone portfolio is also so broad. So we've got flagship consumers who might go for the Buds Plus for the ultimate sound experience. But you've also got the Moto G users who are in the mid-segment and are looking for a great sound experience, but at a more accessible price point. So that's how we've gone with the strategy on the Buds.

Q Speaking about the collaboration with Bose, can you outline specifically what Bose's contribution was to the Moto Buds Plus and how they gave their insight into manufacturing these earbuds? Also, is there any profit sharing that will happen?

A Our partnership with Bose is at multiple levels. Bose is not creating the product, but Bose is helping us with their consumer insights, their expertise, and their knowledge. Right from what drivers we should use to the equalisation and how the sound wave should be. They advised us on how to balance the EQ to ensure that you have the

optimal amounts of bass and the optimal amounts of treble. Even for Active Noise Cancellation, we leverage their insights. Our Buds Plus actually has four levels of ANC where one is a transparency mode, one is an adaptive mode, and so on. So, we've taken deep insights into that.

Secondly, we've also got the advantage of getting our Buds tested within Bose Labs to get the "Sound by Bose" certification. Bose definitely wanted to do the testing in their own labs to be able to give us that certification. Even when it comes to the design and the ergonomics, we've tried to leverage the learnings which Bose has. And of course, there is co-branding, right? This means that there is a co-branding, agreement that we have where both brands will talk about each other and communicate about each other to promote both brands.

Q Now that you mentioned the sound signature, in our testing, we found that the Buds Plus has a V-shaped sound signature with some nuances. Was this intentional to cater to the Indian masses since this is not a typical Bose sound?

A It's a very good point. So, we definitely had a lot of insights from Indian consumers that Indian consumers love bass. So we stuck to Bose's guidelines for the most part in terms of the sound signature and equalisation metrics. But we also gave inputs to tweak it slightly for the Indian market to ensure we addressed their sound needs. If you hear the sound from the Buds+ and the Buds, you will see a difference. The Buds actually has more bass because that's something that we've optimised further. But because Buds Plus was in collaboration with Bose, we tried to stay within the guidelines and see what best we could optimise to ensure that while we address the Indian audience's demands, we still have some of the Bose essence.

Q Is Motorola planning on diversifying its audio portfolio in the future; will it be launching neckband earphones or maybe wired headphones down the line?

A It's difficult for us to comment on our future portfolio, but I think it's important for us to have products that complement our smartphone portfolio and specifically things that are required. As of now, we believe the industry is moving towards wireless. However, depending on the requirements and the needs of our consumers, we are absolutely open to providing them with anything and everything that we feel becomes important from an ecosystem perspective.

Q Motorola phones have generally been pretty well-received over the past couple of years because of Motorola's commitment to offering clean software, really nice and lightweight designs, and sustainable packaging. But most of this is within the online market. So, what are the next steps for Moto to capture more of the smartphone market, particularly offline?

A If you look at the IDC report for Q1 2024, you will see that Motorola has doubled its market share in India and is growing at 110%. So, it is the fastest-growing smartphone brand in India. And it is, of course, moving towards the ambition that we have of becoming the number three player over the next couple of years. So, I think we are well and truly on track to achieve those numbers. We have done a lot of things in our products to differentiate ourselves and to capture the market share. The key point is definitely our design, colours and material choice, which has led to consumers seeing Motorola phones as really premium, aspirational and something that they love to hold, use and even flaunt.

Then, we've also differentiated ourselves with our software experiences, which is not just the Hello UI that you see now on our products, but also Moto Gestures, Moto Secure, Family Spaces, Ready For, and Moto Connect. **d**

